Eastern Michigan University

Undergraduate Conference in Philosophy

2026 Schedule

SATURDAY, NOV. 14th

8:00 AM - 8:50 AM | WELCOME

Tower Room (348):
Join Dr. John Koolage for a brief welcome message and breakfast!

9:00 AM - 9:50 AM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Emma Jones, Eastern Michigan University: “Social Epistemological Themes in the Film Sinners”
Comments: Ellie Johnson, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Daniel Shitandi, St. John's College Sante Fe: "Accepting Extinction: Beyond the Fossil Record"
Comments: Andre Kolak, Stony Brook University

10:00 AM - 10:50 AM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
David Harris, McMaster University: “The Right to Make a World: Communication, Social Facts, and the Limits of the Cosmopolitan Right”
Comments: Zoey Patten, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Justice Dunn, University of Wyoming: “Counterexamples Against Revisionary Ontologies: What Is and What Should Never Be”
Comments: Stephen Armstrong, Eastern Michigan University

11:00 AM - 11:50 AM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Nerea Vidal Arrieta, University of Minnesota: "Democracy and collective well-being"
Comments: RJ (Ronald) Gurunian, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Penelope Sanchez, University of Michigan - Ann Arbor: “On Human Rights and the Necessity of Open Borders”
Comments: Elijah Card, Eastern Michigan University

12:00 PM - 1:15 PM | LUNCH & KEYNOTE

Guild Room (330):
Dr. Brandon Polite, Knox College: ""Collective Listening, Social Virtues, and Popular Music"

SATURDAY, NOV. 14th - Continued

1:30 PM - 2:20 PM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Yushi Bai, Cranbrook Kingswood Upper School: "The Unfinished Case for God"
Comments: Isaac Jensen, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Mason Sanchez-Lassos, Western Michigan University: "An Unwilling Subjugation: Alien Disclosure and the Crisis of Higher Reason"
Comments: Eric Ellerbe, Eastern Michigan University

Guild Room (330):
A2 Ethics High School Presenters

- Amelia Bai: “The Monetization of One's Own Suffering”
- Solmin Kim: “Must a Meaningful Life Be Self-Chosen?”
- Samir Rao: “Performance Enhancing Engineering”

2:30 PM - 3:20 PM | PRESENTATIONS

Alumni Room (342):
George Bowyer, University of Cambridge: "Empirical Adequacy Is an Incomplete Defence of the Proximate-Ultimate Distinction"
Comments: Daniel Shitandi, St. John’s College

Tower Room (348):
Sanaa Taqvi, Claremont Mckenna College: “Yours, Truly? The Ownership and Authorship of Desire”
Comments: Luke Nordberg, Eastern Michigan University

Guild Room (330):
A2 Ethics High School Presenters

- Amy Yang: “The Ethics of Larping”
- Luca Abudeye: “The Start of a Healthy and Fulfilling Life”
- Ryanna RePass: “The Legitimacy of Morality”

3:30 PM - 4:20 PM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Delaney McNear, University of Mississippi - Twin Cities: “Condemned to Be Free, Free to Have Hope: Optimism and Authenticity in Sartrean Existentialism”
Comments: Brooke Bender, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Jonathan Huynh, Oakland University: "Syntax, Semantics, and the Impossibility of Strong AI"
Comments: Everett Peabody, Eastern Michigan University

Guild Room (330):

A2 Ethics High School Presenters

- Sakshi Sivakumar: “The Ethics of Capitalism”
- Hrudya Pingili: “Obligation Without Condemnation: Suicide, Human Nature, and the Ethics of Intervention”
- Peter Johnson: “Axiarchism and Comedic Value”

SUNDAY, NOV. 15th

8:00 AM - 8:50 AM | WELCOME

Tower Room (348):

Join Dr. John Koolage for a brief welcome message and breakfast!

9:00 AM - 9:50 AM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):

Deepthisri Paruchuri, Ohio State University: "The Role of Ancient Chinese Philosophies in Modern Medical Ethics"

Comments: Junhou Chen, University of Michigan - Ann Arbor

Alumni Room (342):

Nadia Jeelani-Socia, University of Cincinnati: "Feminist Approach to Ethical Duties in Healthcare"

Comments: Kayleigh Peace, Eastern Michigan University

10:00 AM - 10:50 AM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):

Raymond Modregon, University of Wyoming: "The Ontology of Non-Representational Art”

Comments: Grace Stockhausen, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):

Matthew Roxas, Purdue University: "Does Artificial Intelligence Truly Reason? Embodiment, Reflection, and the Limits of AI"

Comments: Jason Folk, Eastern Michigan University

11:00 AM - 11:50 AM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):

Samuel Lundy, Santa Clara University: “Philosophy as a Poietic Endeavor: A Comparative Analysis of Martin Heidegger and Daoist Conceptions of Poetics”

Comments: Matthew Roxas, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):

Naina Krishnamurthy, Northern VA Community College: “When Responsibility Disappears: The Harm Attribution Gap and Group Negligence in Public Health"

Comments: Claire Filthaut, Eastern Michigan University

12:00 PM - 1:15 PM | LUNCH

Restaurant of your choice
Enjoy lunch at one of the wonderful restaurants within walking distance of McKenny Hall. Vegetarian and vegan options are available.

SUNDAY, NOV. 15th - Continued

1:30 PM - 2:20 PM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Max Gretchokoff, University of New Mexico: “The Logic of the Animal State Suicide Born from Suffering, Absurdist Revolt, and an Ethics of Survival”
Comments: Ava Ryan-Young, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Rosemary Kendall, Eastern Michigan University: “Structures of Epistemology”
Comments: Joel Collen, Eastern Michigan University

2:30 PM - 3:20 PM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Andre Kolak, “Cene without Me? But Anthro Makes Three! Structural Relations and Necessary Conditions”
Comments: Ava Ryan-Young, Eastern Michigan University

Alumni Room (342):
Graduate Student Panel

3:30 PM - 4:20 PM | PRESENTATIONS

Tower Room (348):
Writing Workshop

4:20 PM - 4:50 PM | CLOSING CEREMONY

Tower Room (348):
Join the UCiP Team as we thank you for your participation!